

THE BOOK OF GOVERNMENT

CHAPTER 1 Preliminary Principles

The Presbyterian Church of the Philippines, in setting forth the form of government which it maintains as being founded upon and agreeable to the Word of god, reiterates, by way of introduction, several great principles which have governed the formation of the plan:

1. That “God alone is Lord of the conscience, and has left it free from the doctrines and commandments of men which are in any thing contrary to his Word, or besides it, in matters of faith or worship.” Therefore we consider the rights of private judgement, in all matters that respect religion, as universal and unalienable. We do not even wish to see any religious constitution aided by the civil power, further than may be necessary for protection and security, and, at the same time, be equal and common to all others.
2. That, in perfect consistency with the above principle of common right, every Christian church, or union or association of particular churches, is entitled to declare the terms of admission into its communion, and the qualifications of its ministers and members, as well as the whole system of its internal government which Christ has appointed: that in the exercise of this right, it may notwithstanding, err, in making the terms of communion either too lax or too narrow; yet, even in this case, it does not infringe upon the liberty or the rights of others but only makes an improper use of its own.
3. That our blessed Savior, for the edification of the visible church, which is his body, has appointed officers, not only to preach the gospel and administer the sacraments, but also to exercise discipline, for the preservation both of truth and duty; and that it is incumbent upon these officers, and upon the whole church, in whose name they act, to censure or cast out the erroneous and scandalous, observing, in all cases, the rules contained in the Word of God.
4. That the truth is in order to goodness; and a great touchstone of truth, its tendency to promote holiness; according to our Savior’s rule, “by their fruits you shall know them.” And that no opinion can be either more pernicious or more absurd than that which brings truth and falsehood upon a level, and represents it as of no consequence what a man’s opinions are. On the contrary, we are persuaded that there is an inseparable connection between faith and practice, truth and duty. Otherwise it would be no consequence either to discover truth or to embrace it.
5. That while, under the conviction of the above principle, we think it necessary to make effectual provisions that all who are admitted as teachers be sound in the faith, we also believe that there are truths and forms with respect to which men of good characters and principles may differ. And in all these we think it the duty both of private Christians and Societies to exercise mutual forbearance toward each other.
6. That, though the character, qualifications and authority of church officers are laid down in the Holy Scriptures, as well as the proper method of their investiture and institution, yet the election of the persons to the exercise of this authority, in any particular society, is in that society.
7. That all church power, whether exercised by the body in general, or in the way of representation by delegated authority, is only ministerial and declarative, that is to say, that the Holy Scriptures are the only rule of faith and manners; that no church judicatory ought to pretend to make laws to bind the conscience in virtue of its own authority; and that all its decisions should be founded the revealed will of God. Now though it will easily be admitted that all synods and councils may err, through the frailty inseparable from humanity, yet there is much greater danger from the usurped claim of making laws, than from the right of judging upon the laws already made and common to all who

profess the gospel; although this right, as necessity requires in the present state, be lodged with fallible men.

8. Lastly, that if the preceding scriptural and rational principles be steadfastly adhered to, the vigor and strictness of its discipline will contribute to the glory and happiness of any church. Since ecclesiastical discipline must be purely moral or spiritual in its object, and not attended with any civil effects, it can derive no force whatever but from its own justice, the approbation of an impartial public, and that countenance and blessing of the great Head of the church universal.

CHAPTER II Of the Church

1. JESUS CHRIST, who is now exalted far above all principality and power, hat erected in this world a kingdom, which is his church.
2. The universal church consists of all those persons, in every nation, together with their children, who make profession of the holy religion of Christ and of submission to his laws.
3. As this immense multitude cannot meet together in one place to hold communion or to worship God, it is reasonable, and warranted by Scripture example, that they should be divided into many particular churches.
4. A particular church consists of a number of professing Christians, with their offspring, voluntarily associated together for divine worship and godly living agreeably to the Holy Scriptures, and submitting to a certain form of government.

CHAPTER III Of the Officers of the Church

1. Our blessed Lord, at first, collected his church out of different nations, and formed it into one body, by the mission of men endued with miraculous gifts which have long since ceased.

2. The ordinary and perpetual officers in the church are ministers, elders and deacons.

CHAPTER IV Of Ministers

1. This office is the first in the Church, both for dignity and usefulness. The person who fills it is given in Scripture different names expressive of his various duties. As he has the oversight of the flock of Christ, he is termed Pastor. As he serves Christ in the church, he is termed Minister. As it is his duty to be serious and prudent and an example to the flock, and to govern well in the house and kingdom of Christ, he is termed Presbyter or Elder. As he is sent to declare the will of God to sinners and to beseech them to be reconciles to God through Christ, he is termed Ambassador. As he bears the glad tidings of salvation to the ignorant and perishing, he is termed Evangelist. As he stands to proclaim the Gospel, he is termed Preacher. As he expounds the Word, and by sound doctrine both exhorts and convinces the gainsay, he is termed Teacher. As he dispenses the manifold grace of God and the ordinances instituted by Christ, he is termed Steward of the mysteries of God. These names do not indicate grades of office, but all described one and the same officer.
2. He that fills this office should be sound in the faith, apt to teach, and should posses a competency of human learning. He should exhibit sobriety and holiness of life becoming the Gospel. He should be a man of wisdom and discretion. He should rule his own house well. He should have good report of them that are outside the Church.
3. As the Lord has given different gifts to the Ministers of the word, and has committed to them various work to execute, the church is authorized to call and appoint them to labor as Pastor, Teachers, and Evangelist, and in such other works as may be needful to the church, according to the gifts in which they excel.
4. When a Minister is called by a congregation to labor as its Pastor, it belongs to his office to pray for with his flock, as the mouth of the

people unto God; to feed the flock, by reading, expounding, and preaching the Word; to direct the congregation in the worship of God; to administer the Sacrament; to invoke the blessing of God upon the people; to catechize the children and youth and to oversee the educational program of the church; to visit regularly the people, devoting special attention to the poor, the sick, the afflicted, and the dying; and; with the other Elders, to exercise the joint power of government.

5. When a Minister is called by a church court or agency of a court to labor as a Teacher in a theological seminary, college, university or school, it appertains to his office to take a pastoral oversight of those committed to his charge, and to be diligent on sowing the seed of the Word and gathering the fruit thereof, as one who cares for souls.
6. When a Minister is called by a Presbytery to labor as an Evangelist, the Presbytery shall commission him to preach the Word and administer the Sacraments in other cities or parts of the church which have no regular ministration of the word. The Presbytery may by a separate act from that by which it commissioned him, entrust to the Evangelist for a period of twelve months the power to organize churches, and, until there is a Session in the church so organized, to instruct, examine, ordain, and install Elders and Deacons therein, and to receive or dismiss members.
7. When Minister is called by a Church court or agency of a court to labor in an administrative capacity, or in the guidance of students attending a college or university, or in the Christian education program of the Church, or in military or institutional chaplaincy, or in any other field of service to the church, it shall be incumbent on him to make full proof of his ministry by disseminating the Gospel for the edification of the Church.

CHAPTER V Of Elders

1. As there were Elders of the people for the government of the Old Testament Church, so under the New Testament Christ has furnished others beside the Minister of the Word with gifts and commission to govern when called thereunto. These officers are the Elders.
2. Elders, the immediate representative of the people, are chosen by them, together with the Ministers they exercise government and discipline, and take the oversight of the spiritual interest both of the particular church and of the church generally when appointed to represent their churches in the higher courts. In all the courts of the church these Elders possess the same authority and the same eligibility to office as the Minister of the Word.
3. Those who fill this office should be blameless in life and sound in the faith, men of wisdom and discretion. By the holiness of their walk and conversation they should be example of Christian faith.
4. It belongs to their office, both individually and jointly, to watch diligently over the congregation committed to their charge, that no corruption of doctrine or of morals enter therein. Evils which they cannot correct by private admonition they should bring to the notice of the Session. They should visit the people at their homes, especially the sick; they should instruct the ignorant, comfort the mourner, nourish and guard the children of the Church. They should pray with and for the people. They should be careful and diligent in seeking the fruit of the preached Word. They should inform the Minister of cases of sickness, affliction and awakening, and of all others which may need his special attention. They should cultivate their aptness to teach the Word, and should supply places destitute of the regular ministry of the Word with the worship of God. All those duties which private Christians are bound to discharge by the law of love are especially incumbent upon the elders by reason of their vocation to office, and are to be discharged by them as official duties.

CHAPTER VI Of Deacons

1. The office of Deacon as set forth in Scripture is one of sympathy and service after the example of Christ. It expresses the love and fellowship of saints who bear one another's burdens.
2. To the office of deacon, which is spiritual in nature, should be chosen men of spiritual character, honest repute, exemplary lives, brotherly love warm sympathies, and sound judgement.
3. It is the duty of the Deacons, first of all, to minister to those who are in need, to the sick, to the friendless, and to any who may be in distress. It is their duty to develop the grace of liberty in the members of the church; to plan, in collaboration with the Session, the objects toward which the offerings of the congregation shall regularly be directed; to plan effective methods for gathering these offerings; to receive other offerings as directed by the Session; and to see that all offerings are distributed among the objects toward which they have been contributed. It is their duty also to have the care of the property of the congregation, both real and personal, and to keep in proper repair the church edifice and other buildings belonging to the congregation. In matters of special importance affecting the property of the church they can take final action only with the consent of the congregation. The regular budget and other important financial matters require the approval of the Session.

CHAPTER VII Of Ordinances in a Particular Church

1. The ordinances established by Christ, the Head, in a particular Church, which is regularly constituted with its proper officers, are prayer, singing praises, reading, expounding and preaching the Word of God, administering baptism and the Lord's Supper, public solemn fasting and thanksgiving, catechizing, making collections for the poor and other pious purposes, exercising discipline, and blessing the people.

CHAPTER VIII Of Church Government, and the Several Kinds of Judicatories

1. It is absolutely necessary that the government of the Church be exercised under some certain and definite form. And we hold it to be expedient, and agreeable to Scripture and practice of the primitive Christians, that the Church be governed by congregational, presbyterial, and synodical assemblies. In full consistency with this belief, we embrace, in the spirit of charity, those Christians who differ from us, in opinion, or in practice, on these subjects.
2. Moreover, without violating our own loyalties, we should it to be needful for us and for all other churches earnestly to seek ways whereby these differences regarding church government, and all other differences, may be overcome in Christ. These ways may lead to organic union among denominational activities in which the churches are represented, not officially but only through their individual members.
3. These assemblies ought not to possess any civil jurisdiction, nor to inflict any civil penalties. Their power is wholly moral or spiritual, and that only ministerial and declarative. They possess the right of requiring obedience to the laws of Christ; and of excluding the disobedient and disorderly from the privileges of the church. To give efficiency, however, to this necessary and Scriptural authority, they possess the powers requisite for obtaining evidence and inflicting censure. They can call before them any offender against the order and government of the Church; they can require members of their own society to appear and give testimony in the cause; but the highest punishment to which their authority extends is to exclude the contumacious and impenitent from the congregation of believers.
4. In these assemblies only members thereof who are personally present are entitled to vote.

CHAPTER IX Of the Church Session

1. The church Session of the minister or ministers and elders of a particular congregation with at least 25 adult baptized members.
2. Of this judicatory, half of the total number of elders and the minister shall be necessary to constitute a quorum.
3. The minister of the congregation shall always be the moderator of the Session, except when, for prudential reasons, it may appear advisable that some other minister should be invited to preside; in which case the minister may, with the concurrence of the Session, invite such other minister as they may see meet, belonging to the same Presbytery, to preside in that case. The same expedient may be adopted in case of the sickness or absence of the minister.
4. It is expedient, at every meeting of the Session, more especially when constituted for judicial business, that there be a presiding minister. When therefore, a church is without a minister, the moderator of the Session shall be either the minister appointed for that purpose by the Presbytery or one invited by the Session to preside on a particular occasion. But where it is impracticable, without great inconvenience to produce the attendance of such a moderator, the Session may proceed informally without it, any action taken at such an informal meeting being subject to ratification at a duly constituted meeting.
5. The church Session is charged with maintaining the spiritual government of the church. For this purpose it has power:
 - a. To inquire into knowledge and Christian conduct of the church members under its care.
 - b. To admonish, to rebuke, to suspend or exclude from the Lord's Supper those found delinquent, according to the Rules of discipline.
 - c. To instruct parents who are communicants to present their children for Baptism.
 - d. To receive members into the communion of the church upon profession of faith in Jesus Christ, upon presentation of satisfactory certificate of dismissal, or in the absence of such certificate, upon reaffirmation of faith in Jesus Christ.
 - e. To grant certificates of dismissal to other churches, which, when given to parents shall always include the names of their children, specifying whether they have been baptized.
 - f. To instruct, examine, ordain, and install Elders and Deacons on their election by the church.
 - g. To require these officers to advice to devote themselves to their responsibility.
 - h. To supervise the work of the Board of Deacons and examine the records of their proceedings.
 - i. To develop and supervise the church school and the educational program of the church.
 - j. To exercise, in accordance with the Directory for Worship, authority over the time place of the preaching of the Word and of the administration of the Lord's Supper, over all other religious services, over the music in the services, and over the uses to which the church building and associated properties may be put.
 - k. To assemble the people for worship when there is no Minister.
 - l. To order collections for Christian purposes
 - m. To devise suitable measures for advancing the spiritual interests of the church and of the congregation.
 - n. . To observe the carry out the lawful injunctions of the higher courts.

- o. To select from among the Elders representatives to the Presbytery and General assembly, who shall, on their return, make report of their participation.
- p. To propose to the Presbytery such measures as may be common advantage to the whole church.

All organization within the particular church shall be subject to the review and control of the Session. Each organization shall, if requested, render stated reports to the Session.

- 6. Every Session shall keep an accurate record of its proceeding which shall be submitted at least once every year to Presbytery for its review and control.
- 7. Every Session shall also keep record of baptisms, of non-communing members, of those admitted to the Lord's Table, of those received from other churches, of those dismissed to other churches, of those placed upon the inactive roll, and of the death and marriages of church members.

CHAPTER X Of the Presbytery

- 1. The church consisting, as it does, of many separate congregations, these need mutual counsel and assistance, in order to preserve soundness of doctrines and regularity of discipline, and to enter into common measures for promoting knowledge and religion, and for preventing infidelity, error and immorality. Hence, arise the importance and usefulness of presbyterial and synodical assemblies.
- 2. A Presbytery consist of all the ministers, in number not less than four, and one elder from each congregation, within a certain district; but the special interest of a particular race, or the desire on the part of ministers and churches to use another language than English in their worship may demand the erection of presbyteries within the bounds of existing presbyteries.

- 3. Every congregation, which has a stated minister, has a right to be represented by one elder; and every collegiate church by two or more elders, in proportion to the number of its ministers.
- 4. Every vacant congregation is regularly organized shall be entitled to be represented by an elder in Presbytery.
- 5. Every elder not known to the Presbytery shall produce a certificate of regular appointment from the church he represents.
- 6. Any two ministers and at least one elder belonging to the Presbytery, being met at the time and place appointed, shall be quorum competent to proceed to business.
- 7. The Presbytery has power:
 - a. To receive and decide references, appeals and complaints brought before it according to constitutional procedures.
 - b. To assume the original jurisdiction in cases in which a Church Session cannot exercise its authority.
 - c. To review the records of Sessions, redress whatever they may have done contrary to order, and take effectual care that they observe the Constitution of the church
 - d. To see that the lawful injunctions of higher courts are obeyed.
 - e. To visit churches for the purpose of inquiring into and redressing the evils that may have arisen in them. When necessary for the welfare of the church the Presbytery may dissolve the active relationship between an Elder or Deacon and the church, provided there has been a hearing which affords procedural safeguards as incases of process.
 - f. To unite or divide churches, at the request of the members thereof.
 - g. To organize new churches.

- h. To received and dismiss churches.
- i. To dissolve churches.
- j. To control the location of new churches and of churches desiring to move to new locations.
- k. To take special oversight of churches without Ministers.
- l. To receive under its care Candidates for the Ministry.
- m. To ordain, received, dismiss, install, remove, and judge Ministers.
- n. To establish the pastoral relationships; and to dissolve it at the request of one or both of the parties, or when it finds that the interests of religion imperatively demand it, following a hearing which provides procedural safeguards as in cases of process.
- o. To set apart Ministers to labor as Teachers, Evangelist, and in other works proper to the Ministry of the Gospel.
- p. To require Ministers to devote themselves diligently to their sacred calling and to censure the delinquent.
- q. To devise measures for the enlargement of the Church within its bounds.
- r. To condemn erroneous opinions which injure the purity of peace of the Church.
- s. To order whatever pertains to the spiritual welfare of the churches under its care.
- t. To institute and superintend the agencies necessary for its work.
- u. To select commissioners to the General Assembly.

- v. To propose to the Assembly such measures as may be common advantage to the whole Church.

8. The Presbytery shall keep a full and accurate record of its proceedings, and shall send it up to the Synod annually for review. It shall report to the General Assembly every year the condition and progress of religion within its bound during the year; and all the important changes which may have taken place, such as the ordinations, the receiving or dismissing of members, the removal of members by death, the union and the division of churches, and the formation of new ones.
9. The Presbytery shall hold stated meetings at least twice a year. When any emergency shall require a meeting earlier than the time to which the Presbytery stands adjourned, the Moderator shall, at the request, or with the concurrence, of two Ministers and of two Elders representing at least two churches, call a special meeting. Should the Moderator be for any reason unable to act, the Clerk shall, under the same requirements, issue the call. If both Moderator and Clerk are unable to act, any three Ministers and two Elders representing at least two churches shall have power to call a meeting. Notice of the special meeting shall be sent not less than ten days in advance to each Minister and to the Session of every church without a Minister. In the notice the purpose of the meeting shall be stated, and no business other than that named in the notice is to be transacted. The Presbytery shall also convene when directed so to do by the Synod, for the transaction of designated business only.

CHAPTER XI Of the General Assembly

1. The General Assembly is the highest judicatory of the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines. It shall represent, in one body, all the particular churches of this denomination; and shall bear the title of THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH OF THE PHILIPPINES.

2. The General Assembly shall consist of one minister and one elder for every 200 baptized members from every Presbytery.
3. Any twenty or more of these commissioners, being met on the day and at the place appointed, shall be quorum for the transaction of business.
4. The General Assembly shall receive and issue all appeals, complaints and references that affect the doctrine or constitution of the church and are regularly brought before it from the lower judicatories, provided that in administrative or judicial cases the General Assembly shall have power to act by commission, subject to the provisions of the Book of Discipline. The General Assembly shall review the records of every Presbytery and approve or censure them; it shall give its advice and instruction in all cases submitted to it, in conformity with the constitution of the church; and it shall constitute the bond of union, peace, correspondence and mutual confidence among all our churches.
5. The General Assembly shall have power:
 - a. To decide all references, appeals and complaints regularly brought before it from the lower courts.
 - b. To bear testimony against error in doctrine and immorality in practice, injuriously affecting the Church.
 - c. To decide finally in all controversies brought before it respecting doctrine, order and discipline
 - d. To give its advice and instruction, in conformity with the Constitution, in all cases submitted to it.
 - e. To review the records of the Synods.
 - f. To take cares that the lower courts observe the Constitution.
 - g. To redress whatever the lower courts may have done contrary to order.
 - h. To organize measures for advancing the prosperity and enlargement of the Church.
 - i. To establish new Presbyteries.
 - j. To institute and superintend the agencies necessary in the general work of the church.
 - k. To appoint Ministers to such labors as fall under its jurisdiction.
 - l. To suppress divisive contentions and disputations, according to the rules provided therefor.
 - m. To receive under its jurisdiction, with the consent of three fourths of the Presbyteries, other ecclesiastical bodies whose organization is conformed to the doctrine and order of this church.
 - n. To authorize Presbyteries to exercise similar power in receiving bodies suited to become constituents of those courts, and lying within their geographical bounds respectively.
 - o. To superintend the affairs of the whole Church.
 - p. To corresponds with other churches.
 - q. To unite with other ecclesiastical bodies whose organization is conformed to the doctrines and order of this Church, such union to be effected by a mode of procedure defined elsewhere in the Form of Government.
 - r. To recommend measures for the promotion of charity, truth, and holiness through all the churches under its care.
6. The General Assembly shall meet at least once a year. On the day appointed for that purpose the Moderator of the last assembly, if present, shall open the meeting with sermon, or, in the case of his absence, the Vice-Moderator shall open the meeting with a sermon and preside. No commissioner shall have a right to deliberate or vote in the assembly until his name shall have been enrolled, and his commission examined and filed among the papers of the assembly.

7. Each session of the assembly shall be and closed with prayer. And the whole business of the assembly being finished, and the vote taken for dissolving the present assembly, the moderator shall say from the chair “By virtue of the authority delegated to me by the church, let this General Assembly be dissolved, and I do hereby dissolve it, and require another assembly, chosen in the same manner. to meet at _____ on the _____ day of _____,” after which he shall pray and return thanks, and pronounce on those present the apostolic benediction.

CHAPTER XII Of the Board of Deacons

1. In order to facilitate the performance of the duties of their office, the deacons of each particular church shall, with the minister, be constituted a Board of Deacons.
2. The minister shall be the moderator of the board, but a member appointed by the minister may serve when he is not present. The other officers shall be chosen from the membership of the board.
3. The board shall make a quarterly report of its activities, including its disbursements, to the Session.

CHAPTER XIII Of Electing and Ordaining

1. Every congregation shall elect persons to the office of elder, and to the office of deacon, or either of them, in the most approved and in use in that congregation. In all cases the persons elected must be members in full communion in the church in which they are to exercise their office.
2. When any person shall have been elected to either of these offices, and shall have declared his willingness to accept thereof, he shall be set apart in the following manner:
3. After sermon, the minister shall state in a concise manner the warrant and nature of the office of elder or deacon, together with the character

proper to be sustained, and the duties to be fulfilled by the officer elect; having done this, he shall propose to the candidate, in the presence of the congregation, the following questions:

- a. Do you believe the Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments to be Word of God, the only infallible rule of faith and practice?
- b. Do you sincerely receive and adopt the Confession of Faith and Catechisms of this church, as containing the system of doctrine taught in the Holy Scriptures?
- c. Do you approve of the government and discipline of The Presbyterian Church of the Philippines?
- d. Do you accept the office of elder (or deacon as the case may be) in this congregation, and promise faithfully to perform all the duties thereof?
- e. Do you promise to study the purity, peace and unity of the church?

The elder, or deacon, elect having answered these questions in the affirmative, the minister shall address to the members of the church the following question:

Do you, the member of this church, acknowledge and received this brother as an elder (or deacon), and do you promise to yield him all that honor, encouragement and obedience in the Lord to which his office, according to the Word of god, and the constitution of this church entitles him?

The members of the church having answered this question in the affirmative, by holding up their right hands, the minister shall proceed to set apart the candidate by prayer to the office of elder (or deacon, as the case may be), and shall give him and to the congregation an exhortation suited to the occasion.

4. Where there is an existing Session, it is proper that the member of that body, at the close of the service, and in the face of the congregation, take the newly ordained elder by the hand, saying in words to this purpose, “We give you the right hand of fellowship, to take part of this office with us.”
5. The offices of elder deacon are both perpetual, and cannot be laid aside at pleasure. No person can be divested of either office but by deposition. Yet an elder or deacon may become, by age or infirmity, incapable of performing the duties of his office; or he may, though chargeable with neither heresy nor immorality, become unacceptable, in his official character, to a majority of the congregation to which belongs. In either of these cases, he may as often happens with respect to a minister, cease to be an acting elder or deacon.
6. Whenever an elder or deacon, from either of these causes or from any other not inferring crime, shall be incapable of serving the church to edification, the Session shall take order on the subject, and state fact, together with the reason of it, on their records, provided always, that nothing of this kind shall be done without the concurrence of the individual in question, unless by the advice of Presbytery.
7. The elders and deacons shall serve for a term of three years, after which they shall be presented to the congregation for re-election. They shall serve for not more than two consecutive terms. An elder or deacon who has served for two consecutive terms or one who failed to get congregational vote shall not be eligible until a full term break has lapsed. The Session or board of deacons shall be made to consist of three classes, one of which only shall be elected every year.

CHAPTER XIV Of Ministerial Candidates And Their Licensure

A. Of Candidate For The Gospel Ministry

1. The holy Scriptures require that some trial be previously had of them who are to be ordained to the ministry of the gospel, that his sacred office may not be degraded by being committed to weak or unworthy men; and that the churches may have an opportunity to form a better judgement respecting the talents of those by whom they are to be instructed and governed. For this purpose presbyteries may receive and enroll as candidates for licensure and ordination such persons as in their judgement give decided promise of usefulness in the sacred office, after having received the training and trial of their talents hereinafter prescribed.
2. A candidate for the ministry is a member of the Church in full communion who, believing himself to be called to preach the gospel, is enrolled as such by a Presbytery and under its direction pursues a course of study and practical training to prepare himself for the ministry.
3. Every candidate for the ministry shall put himself under the care of a Presbytery, which be the Presbytery that has jurisdiction of the church of which he is a member.
4. Every applicant seeking to be taken under the care of a Presbytery as a candidate for the ministry shall be a communicant member of a particular church within the bounds of said Presbytery and for a prior period of at least six months. Said applicant shall be filed with the clerk of the Presbytery through the Session of the particular church and with its approval, and shall be in his hands at least three months prior to consideration, during which time a close and particular examination shall be made of the character and conduct of the candidate, of his physical, mental, and educational qualifications and of the motives which have influenced him to desire the sacred office,

by the appropriate committee of the Presbytery. The report of this committee to the Presbytery shall contain evidence of a careful consideration of the candidate's qualifications in these and other respects which have a bearing upon his qualifications for the ministry. This report shall also contain specifically the recommendation of the committee as to whether the applicant should or should not be received under the care of the Presbytery. Exceptions to any one or more of these requirements may be made only by a three fourths vote of the members of Presbytery present and the reasons for each exception shall be spread in full upon the minutes of the Presbytery for transmission to and review by the synod.

5. After the committee has made its report concerning the reception of an applicant he shall appear before the Presbytery in person, and shall be examined by the Presbytery on experimental religion and on his motives for seeking the ministry.

If the testimonials and the examination prove satisfactory, the Presbytery shall receive him under its care as a candidate after the following manner:

The moderator shall propose to him the following questions, namely:

- a. Do you, as far as you know your own heart, believe yourself to be called to the office of the Christian ministry?
- b. Do you promise in reliance upon the grace of God to maintain a Christian character and conduct, and to be diligent and faithful in making full preparation for the holy ministry?
- c. Do you promise to submit yourself to the proper supervision of the Presbytery in matters that concern your preparation for the Holy ministry?

- d. Do you desire now to be received by this Presbytery as a candidate for the holy ministry in the Presbyterian Church in the Philippines?

If these question be answered in the affirmative, the moderator or someone appointed by him shall give the candidate is then to be recorded on the Presbytery's role of candidates for licensure and ordination to the gospel ministry.

6. The candidate continues to be communicant member of the particular church and subject to the jurisdiction or its Session. But as respecting his preparatory training for the ministry, he is under the oversight of the Presbytery. It shall be the duty of the Presbytery to show a kindly and sympathetic interest in him, and to give him counsel and guidance in regard to his studies his practical training, and the institution of learning he should attend. In no case may candidate omit from his course of study any of the subjects prescribed in the Book of Government as test for licensure and ordination without obtaining the consent of the Presbytery; and where such consent is given, the Presbytery shall record the fact and the reasons therefor.
7. For the development of his Christian character, for the service he can render, and for his effective training, the candidate, when entering on his theological studies, should be authorized and encouraged by the Presbytery to conduct public worship, to expound the Scriptures to the people, and to engage in other forms of Christian work. These forms of service should be rendered under the direction of Presbytery, and also with the sanction and under the guidance of the candidate's instructors during the time of his being under their instruction. A candidate should not undertake to serve statedly a church which is without a pastoral unless he has the approval of the Presbytery having jurisdiction of the church. Under no circumstances whatever is he authorized to administer the sacraments or perform a marriage ceremony.
8. The Presbytery shall require every candidate for the ministry under its care to make a report to it at least once a year; and it shall secure from

his instructors an annual report upon his department, diligence and progress in study.

9. The Presbytery may, upon application of the candidate, give him a certificate of dismission to another Presbytery, valid when he has transferred his communicant membership to a particular church within the bounds of said Presbytery, and a candidate may, at his request, be allowed to withdraw from the care of the Presbytery. The Presbytery may also, for sufficient reasons, remove the name of a candidate from its roll of candidates; but in such case it shall report its action and the reason therefor to the candidate, to the Session of his church. and to the institution of learning in which he is pursuing his studies.

B. Of The Licensure Of Candidates For The Gospel Ministry

1. A candidate for the ministry is licensed by the Presbytery to preach the gospel in order that, after he has made sufficient trial of his gifts and the Presbytery has received assurance of his approval by the Church, He may be ordained to the sacred office of the ministry. Until he is so ordained he continue to be a communicant member of a particular church. Before receiving license to preach, the candidate shall have been under Presbytery's care for at least one year. Exception to this requirement may be made only by three fourths vote of the members of Presbytery present and the reason for such exception shall be spread in full upon the minutes of the Presbytery for transmission to review by the synod.
2. The trials of a candidates applying for licensure shall be had by the Presbytery under whose care he has placed himself. But if he desires to labor within the bounds of another Presbytery, his own Presbytery may dismiss him to that Presbytery for licensure.
3. The candidate shall be examined by the Presbytery, or by a committee appointed for that purpose. And in order to make trial of his talents to explain and vindicate, and practically to enforce, the doctrine of the Gospel, the Presbytery shall further require that the candidate prepare

(1) sermon, which the Presbytery may ask to be delivered in its presence, (2) an essay on a theological theme, and (3) discipline and (4) worship as prescribed in the Book of Worship of the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines.

4. That the most effectual measures may be taken to guard against the admission of unqualified men into the sacred office, no exception shall be made to any of the educational or other requirements outlined above unless the Presbytery, after referring the whole matter to the general assembly for advice, shall judge, by a three-fourths vote of the members present, that the such exception is warranted by the exceptional qualifications of the candidate in question.
5. If the Presbytery be satisfied with the trials of a candidate for licensure, it shall then proceed to license him in the following manner. The moderator shall propose to him the following questions;
 - a. Do you believe the Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments to be the Word of God, the only infallible rule of faith and practice?
 - b. Do you sincerely receive and adopt the Confession of Faith and Catechism of this church as containing the system of doctrine taught in the Holy Scriptures?
 - c. Do you promise to study the purity, peace and unity of the church?
 - d. Do you promise to submit yourself, in the Lord, to the government of this Presbytery, or of any other Presbytery in the bounds of which you may be called?
6. The candidate having answered these questions in the affirmative, and the moderator having offered up a prayer suitable to the occasion, he shall address himself to the candidate to the following purpose: "In the name of the Lord Jesus Christ, and by that authority which he has given to the Church for its edification, we do license you to preach the

gospel, wherever God in his providence may call you: and for this purpose, may the blessing of God rest upon you and the Spirit of Christ fill your heart. Amen”; and record shall be made of the licensure in the following or like form:

At the day of the Presbytery of having good through a regular course of literature, of his good moral character, and of his being in the communion of the church, proceeded to take usual parts of trial for his licensure; and he having given satisfaction as to his accomplishments in literature, as to his experience mental acquaintance with religion, and as to his proficiency in divinity and other studies, the Presbytery did, and hereby does, express its approbation of all these parts of trial; and having adopted the Confession of Faith of this church, and satisfactorily answered the questions appointed to be put to candidates to be licensed, by the Presbytery did, and hereby does, license him, the said , to preach the gospel of Christ as a probation for the holy ministry within the bounds of this Presbytery, or wherever else he shall be orderly called.

7. When any candidate for licensure shall have occasion, while his trials are going on, to remove from the bounds of his own Presbytery into those of another, it shall be considered as regular for the latter Presbytery, on his producing proper testimonials from the former to take up his trials at the point at which they were left, and conduct them to a conclusion, in the same manner as if they had been commenced by themselves.
8. In like manner, when any candidate, after licensure, shall by the permission of his Presbytery, remove without its limits, an extract of the record of his licensure, accompanied with a presbyterial recommendation, signed by the clerk, shall be his testimonials to the Presbytery under whose care he shall come.
9. When a licentiate shall have been preaching for considerable time and his service do not appear to be edifying to the churches, the Presbytery may, if think proper, recall his license.

CHAPTER XV Of the Election of Ministers And Of Ordination to the Ministry

1. When any of the people of any congregation appear to elect a minister, the Session shall take measures to convene them for this purpose; and it shall always be a duty of the Session to convene them, when a majority of the person entitled to vote in the case shall by petition request that a meeting may be called.
2. When such a meeting is intended, the Sessions shall solicit the presence and council of some neighboring minister to assist them in conducting the election contemplated, unless highly inconvenient on account of distance; in which case they may proceed without assistance.
3. On a Lord’s day, immediately after the public worship, it shall be intimated from the pulpit that all the members of that congregation are requested to meet on ensuing, at the church, or usual place for holding public worship, then and there, it be agreeable to them, to proceed to the election of a minister for that congregation.
4. On the day appointed, the minister invited to preside, if he be present, shall it be deemed expedient, preach a sermon; and after sermon he shall announce to the people that he will immediately proceed to take the votes of the electors of that congregation for a minister, if such be their desire; and when this desire shall be expressed by a majority of voices, he shall then proceed to take votes accordingly. In this election no person shall be entitled to vote who is not a member in good and regular standing of the particular church.
5. When the votes are taken, if it appear that a large minority of the people are averse from the candidate who has majority of votes and cannot be induced to concur in the call, the presiding minister shall endeavor to dissuade the congregation from the prosecuting it further. But if the people be nearly, or entirely unanimous, or if the majority shall insist upon their right to call a minister, the presiding minister, in

that case, shall proceed to draw a call in due form and to have it subscribed by the electors or their duly authorized representatives; all which proceedings shall be laid before the Presbytery, together with the call.

6. The call shall be in the following or like form:

The congregation of _____ being, on sufficient grounds, well satisfied of the ministerial qualifications of you, _____, and having good hopes that your ministration in the gospel will be profitable to our spiritual interests, do earnestly call and desire you to undertake the pastoral office in said congregation; promising you in discharge of your duty all proper support, encouragement and obedience in the Lord. And that you may be free from worldly care and avocations, we promise and oblige ourselves to pay you the sum of _____ in regular monthly payment during the time of your being and continuing the regular minister of this church, together with free children's education, medical insurance, free use of house, car and vacation each year.

The call shall be subscribed to by the members of the church, and shall be certified by the moderator of the meeting.

7. If any congregation shall choose to subscribe their call by their elders and deacons, or by a select committee, they shall be at liberty to do so. But it shall, in such case, be fully certified to the Presbytery, by the minister or other person preside, that the persons signing have been appointed for that purpose by a public vote of the congregation, and that the call has been, in all other respect, prepared as above directed.
8. When a call shall be presented to a minister or candidate, it shall always be viewed as a sufficient petition from the people for his installation. The acceptance of a call by a minister or candidates shall always be considered as a request, on his part, to be installed at the same time. And when a candidate shall be ordained in consequence of

a call from any congregation, the Presbytery shall at the same time, if practicable, install him minister of that congregation.

9. The call, thus prepared, shall be presented to the Presbytery under whose care the person called shall be, so that if the Presbytery think it expedient to present the call to him it may be accordingly presented; and no minister or candidate shall receive a call but through the hands of the Presbytery.
10. If the call be to a licentiate of another Presbytery, in that case the commissioners deputed from the congregation to prosecute the call shall produce to that judicatory a certificate from their own Presbytery, regularly attested by the moderator and clerk, that the call has been laid before them and that it is in order. If that Presbytery present the call to its licentiate, and he be disposed to accept it, it shall then dismiss him from its jurisdiction, and require him to repair to that Presbytery into the bonds of which he is called and there to submit himself to the usual trials preparatory to ordination.
11. Trials for ordination, especially in a different Presbytery from that in which the candidate was licensed, shall consist of a careful examination as to his acquaintance with experimental religion; to his knowledge of theology, ecclesiastical history, government and discipline of the church the Greek and Hebrew languages, and such other branches of learning as to the Presbytery may appear requisite; and as to his knowledge of the constitution, the rules and principles of the government and discipline of the church; together with such written discourse, or discourses, founded on the Word of God, as to the Presbytery shall seem proper. The Presbytery being fully satisfied with his qualifications for the sacred office, shall appoint a day for his ordination, which ought to be, if covenant, in that church of which ought to be, if convenient, in that church of which he is to be the minister. It is also recommended that a fast day be observed in the congregation previous to the day of ordination.

12. The day appointed for ordination being come and the Presbytery convened, a minister, previously appointed to that duty, shall preach a sermon adapted to the occasion. A member of the Presbytery appointed to preside shall afterwards briefly recite from the pulpit, in the audience of the people, the proceedings of the Presbytery preparatory to this transaction; he shall point out the nature and importance of the ordinance, and endeavor to impress the audience with a proper sense of the solemnity of the transaction.

Then addressing himself to the candidate, he shall propose to him the following questions:

- a. Do you believe the Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments to be the Word of God, the only infallible rule of faith and practice?
- b. Do you sincerely receive and adopt the Confession of Faith and Catechism of this church, as containing the system of doctrine taught in the Holy Scriptures?
- c. Do you approve of the government and discipline of the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines?
- d. Do you promise subjection to your brethren in the Lord?
- e. Have you been induced, as far as you know your own heart, to seek the office of the holy ministry from love to God and sincere desire to promote his glory in the gospel of his son?
- f. Do you promise to be zealous and faithful in maintaining the truths of the Gospel, and the purity and peace of the church, whatever persecution or opposition may arise unto you on that account?
- g. Do you engage to be faithful and diligent in the exercise of all private and personal duties which become you as a Christian and a minister of the gospel, as well as in all relative duties and the public duties of your office, endeavoring to adorn the

profession of the gospel by your conversation, and walking with exemplary piety before the flock over which God shall make you overseer?

If the candidate is to be installed in the church as pastor he shall be asked further with the following question:

- h. Are you now willing to take the charge of this congregation, agreeably to your declaration when you accepted their call? And do you promise to discharge the duties of a minister to them as God shall give you strength?

13. The candidate having answered these questions in the affirmative, the presiding minister shall propose to the people the following questions if he is to be installed in the church as pastor:

- a. Do you, the people of this congregation, continue to profess your readiness to receive , whom you have called to be your minister?
- b. Do you promise to receive the word of truth from his mouth with meekness and love, and to submit to him in the due exercise of discipline?
- c. Do you promise to encourage him in his arduous labor and to assist his endeavors for your instruction and spiritual edification?
- d. And do you engage to continue to him, while he is your minister, that competent worldly maintenance which you have promised, and whatever else you may see needful for the honor of religion and his comfort among you.

14. The people having answered these questions in the affirmative by holding up their right hands, the candidate shall kneel down in the most convenient part of the church. Then the presiding minister shall, by prayer and with the laying on of hands of the Presbytery, according to the apostolic example, solemnly ordain him to the holy office of the

gospel ministry. Prayer being ended, he shall rise from his knees; and the minister who presides shall first, and afterward all the members of the Presbytery in their order, take him by the right hand, saying, in words to this purpose, “We give you the right hand of fellowship, to take part of this ministry with us.” After which the minister presiding, or some other appointed for the purpose, shall give a solemn charge in the name of God to the newly ordained minister and to the people, to persevere in the charge of their duties, and shall then, by prayer, recommend them both to grace of God and his holy keeping. Finally, at the conclusion of the whole service, he shall dismiss the congregation with the usual blessing. and the Presbytery shall duly record the transaction.

15. As a candidate who has not received a call to be the minister of a particular congregation may be called to engage in the work of an evangelist or of a teacher of the Word of god, it is proper that he should be ordained to the gospel ministry, and in this case the last of the preceding questions shall be omitted and the following used as a substitute:

Are you willing to undertake the work of an evangelist (or teacher), and do you promise to discharge the duties which may be incumbent upon you in this character as God may give you strength?

16. When an ordained minister of another denomination seeks admission to the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines, the Presbytery to which he applies shall require him to give evidence of possessing the qualifications, in regard to piety, faith and learning, which are demanded of candidates for ordination as given above, provided, however, that in no case shall examination in theology on the floor of the Presbytery be waived; and it shall require him to answer affirmatively the questions appointed for the ordination of candidates in section 12 of this chapter.

CHAPTER XVI Of Translation, or Removing a Minister From One Charge to Another

1. No minister shall be translated from one church to another, nor shall be receive any call for that purpose, but by the permission of the Presbytery.
2. Any church desiring to call a settled minister from his present charge shall, by commissioners properly authorized, represent to the Presbytery the ground on which they plead his removal. The Presbytery, having maturely considered their plea, may, according as it appears more or less reasonable, either recommend to them to desist from prosecuting the call or order it to be delivered to the minister to whom it is directed.
3. When the congregation calling any settled minister is within the limits of another Presbytery, that congregation shall obtain leave from the Presbytery to which it belongs to apply to the Presbytery of which he is a member; and that Presbytery, having cited him and his congregation as before directed, shall proceed to hear the cause and bring it to an issue. If it agrees to the translation, it shall release him from his present charge, and having given him proper testimonials, shall require him to repair to that Presbytery within the bounds of which the congregation calling him lies, that the proper steps may be taken for his regular settlement in that congregation; and the Presbytery to which the congregation belongs, received an authenticated certificate of his release, under the hand of clerk of that Presbytery, shall proceed to install him in the congregation as soon as convenient. Provided always, that no minister shall be translated without his own consent previously obtained.
4. When any minister is to be settled in a congregation, the installation, which consists in constituting a pastoral relation between him and the people of that particular church, may be performed either by the Presbytery or by a committee appointed for that purpose, as may

appear most expedient; and the following order shall be observed therein:

5. A day shall be appointed for the installation at such time as may appear most convenient, and due notice thereof to the congregation.
6. When the Presbytery, or committee, shall be convened and constituted on the day appointed, a sermon shall be delivered by a minister previously appointed thereto; immediately after which, the minister who is to preside shall state to the congregation the design of the meeting and briefly recite the proceedings of the Presbytery relative thereto. And then, addressing himself to the minister to be installed, shall propose to him the following or similar questions:

(a) Are you willing to take charge of this congregation as its minister, agreeably to your declaration when you accepted its call?

(b) Do you conscientiously believe and declare, as far as you know your own heart, that in taking upon you this charge, you are influenced by a sincere desire to promote the glory of God and the good of his church?

(c) Do you solemnly promise that, by the assistance of the grace of God, you will endeavor faithfully to discharge all the duties of a minister to this congregation, and will be careful to maintain a department in all respects becoming a minister of the gospel of Christ, agreeably to your ordination engagements?

Having received satisfactory answer to all these questions, he shall propose to the people the same or like questions as those directed under the head of ordination; which having been also satisfactorily answered by the holding up of the right hand in testimony of assent, he shall solemnly pronounce and declare the said minister to be regularly constituted the minister of that congregation. A charge shall then be given to both parties, as directed in the case of ordination; and prayer shall be offered. At the conclusion of the whole service the congregation shall be dismissed with the usual benediction.

7. It is highly becoming that, after the installation, the heads of families of that congregation who are then present, or at least the elders and deacons, should come forward to their minister and give him their right hand in token of cordial reception and affectionate regard.

CHAPTER XVII Of Resigning a Pastoral Charge

1. When a minister shall desire leave to resign his pastoral charge, the Presbytery shall cite the congregation to appear, by its commissioners, at its next meeting to show cause why the Presbytery should not accept the resignation. If the congregation fail to appear, or if its reason for retaining its minister be deemed by the Presbytery insufficient, he shall have leave granted to resign his pastoral charge, of which due record shall be made, and that church shall be held to be vacant, till supplied again in an orderly manner with another minister; and if any congregation shall desire to be released from its pastor, a similar process, shall be observed.

CHAPTER XVIII Of the Work of the Evangelist (Missionary)

1. While the evidence available may not be sufficient to determine whether the title “evangelist,” as used in the New Testament, has reference to persons who exercise an office or function that is intended to be permanent in the New Testament church or designates rather as office or function peculiar to the apostolic age like that of apostle and prophet, yet the term evangelist remains today a proper and useful one in the Christian Church. The word evangelist aptly describes one who in charge with the proclamation of the gospel. And the title evangelist may properly be continued as a covenant designation of the minister of the Word whose functions are not specifically those of the pastor or of the teacher. The divine command to declare the glad tidings of salvation to all men requires that the official ministry of the Word, committed to the visible church, embrace types of ministry that pastors

and teachers cannot ordinarily perform because their specific duties restrict the sphere of their labors. Those who finally minister the Word in accordance with Christ's institution but are neither pastors nor teachers may most suitably be called evangelists.

2. The evangelist in common with other ministers is ordained to preach the Word, to administer the sacraments, and to perform the other functions that belong to the sacred office of the minister. Among the distinctive functions which the evangelist may properly perform are
 - (a) the ministry of the gospel in home or foreign mission fields;
 - (b) the ministry of the gospel as stated supply or special preacher in churches to which he does not sustain a pastoral relation;
 - (c) the ministry of the gospel as chaplain in institutions or in the armed forces;
 - (d) the ministry of the gospel in an administrative capacity; and
 - (e) the ministry of the gospel through the press.
3. A minister who has been ordained as a pastor or teacher may become an evangelist if he ceases to perform the function for which he was ordained and undertakes the work of an evangelist, and a minister ordained as an evangelist, and a minister ordained as an evangelist may become a pastor or teacher when called to perform either function. When a pastor or teacher becomes an evangelist, or when an evangelist becomes a pastor or teacher, the Presbytery of which he is a member shall take formal cognizance of such change of function.

CHAPTER XIX Of Moderators, General Secretary and Recording Clerks

1. It is equally in the judicatories of the church, as in other assemblies, that there should be a moderator, that the business may be conducted with order and dispatch.

2. The Moderator is to be considered as possessing, by delegation from the whole body, all authority necessary for the preservation of order, for convening and adjourning the judicatory. If the judicatory be equally divided on any question, he shall possess the casting vote. If he be not willing to decide, he shall put the question a second time; and if the judicatory be again equally divided, and he decline to give his vote, the question shall be lost. And in the case of the Moderator of the Presbytery, he shall likewise be empowered on any extraordinary emergency, to convene the judicatory by a circular letter before the ordinary time of meeting and he shall also serve until his successor be inducted into office.
3. The Moderator of the Presbytery shall be chosen for a term of one year, or for some shorter term if the Presbytery may think best. The moderator of the general assembly shall be chosen to each meeting of their judicatory; and the moderator of the preceding assembly or, in case of his absence, another member appointed for the purpose, shall open the next meeting with a sermon, and shall hold the chair till a new moderator be chosen.
4. Every judicatory shall choose a Recording Clerk to record its transactions, to serve for a term of one year. It shall be the duty of the clerk, besides recording the transactions, to preserve the records carefully, and to grant extracts from them whenever properly required; and such extracts under the hand of the clerk shall be considered as authentic vouchers of the fact which they declare, in any ecclesiastical judicatory and to every part of the church.. He may be chosen to serve for another term according to the pleasure of the judicatory.
5. The General Assembly shall choose a General Secretary who shall be the stated overall executive officer of the church. He shall be responsible in administering, coordinating and directing its operations and transactions according to the rules of the church. He shall serve for a term of two years. He may be chosen to serve for another term according to the pleasure of the General Assembly.

CHAPTER XX Of Missions

1. When vacancies become so numerous in any Presbytery that they cannot be supplied with the frequent administration of the Word and ordinances, it shall be proper for such Presbytery, or any vacant congregation within its bounds with the leave of the Presbytery, to apply to any other Presbytery, or to the general assembly, for such assistance as it can afford. And when any Presbytery shall send any of its ministers or probationers to distant vacancies, the missionary shall be ready to produce his credentials to the Presbytery or presbyteries through the bounds of which he may pass, and to obtain their approbation. And the general assembly may, of its own knowledge, in extraordinary circumstances, send missions to any part to plant churches, provided always that such missions be made with the consent of the parties appointed, and that the parties appointed will speedily place themselves and their work under the jurisdiction of any Presbytery within whose bounds they may be laboring, and that the judicatory sending them make the necessary provision for their support and reward in the performance of this service.

CHAPTER XXI Of Vacant Congregations Assembling For Public Worship

1. Considering the great importance of weekly assembling the people for the public worship of God, in order thereby to improve their knowledge, to confirm their habits of worship and their desire of the public ordinances, to augment their reverence for the most high God, and to promote the charitable affections which unite men most firmly in society, it is recommended that every vacant congregation meet together on the Lord's day, at one or more places, for the purpose of prayer, singing praises and reading the Holy Scriptures, together with the works of such approved divines as the Presbytery within whose bounds they are may recommend and they may be able to procure and that the elders be the persons who shall preside, and select the portions

of Scripture and of the other books to be read, and to see that the whole be conducted in a becoming and orderly manner.

2. Presbyteries may supervise vacant churches within their bounds through a committee or committees appointed for this purpose, or through the moderators who have been appointed for the Sessions. Such supervision includes cooperation with the Session, or with any authorized committee of the particular church, in the supply of the pulpit and in the seeking and securing of a pastor.
3. Only ministers and licentiates of the church shall be employed as regular supplies in vacant churches.

CHAPTER XXII Of Organizations of Members of the Church

1. The members of the church may associate together under proper forms of association, for benevolent, missionary or other religious purposes, provided, however, that, when such organizations purport to represent a particular church or a Presbytery, or The Presbyterian Church of the Philippines, they must obtain the approval, and be subject to the jurisdiction and oversight, of the Session of the particular church, or of the Presbytery, or of the General Assembly, respectively.

CHAPTER XXIII Of Amendments

1. Amendments or alterations of the Form of Government, Book of Discipline and Directory for the Public Worship of God may be made only in the following manner: the General Assembly, after due discussion, may propose changes to the presbyteries before the next ensuing assembly and it shall be the duty of the next ensuing assembly to declare that such changes have been adopted and are in effect.
2. Amendments or alterations of the Confession of Faith and Catechisms, and of the forms of subscription required of ministers, licentiates, elders and deacons as these forms are found in the form of Government, shall not be regarded as having constitutional validity

unless sent down to the presbyteries by a two-thirds of the presbyteries in writing, and finally adopted by a two-thirds vote of the general assembly next ensuing. Before any of the changes described in this section are proposed to the presbyteries, the general assembly shall appoint a committee to consider the proposal changes and to report to the next assembly.

3. None of the provisions of section 2 of this chapter nor of this third section shall be modified except by the process which is set forth in section 2.